

More recently, they were limiting it to five coupons per day with your store card. For that miniscule savings, I don't even bother making the trip.

Downloaded coupon savings on a single item is hardly going to appeal to the extreme couponer, but it might prompt someone who has never bothered to clip a paper coupon to take advantage of the savings. Just as with any new technology, there has been a transition period as shoppers and retailers become more comfortable with digital promotions. Some industry experts are skeptical that consumers will download iPhone apps for all the brands they purchase, but they have proven to appeal to a tech-savvy generation that was not tempted to use paper coupons.

Technology also plays a vital role in the lives of today's mothers, and since they reportedly control a whopping 80 percent of all household spending, marketers have had to take note of the time they spend on the Internet. Time on the Internet is the one activity that actually increases after a woman has a baby, maybe because they are searching for the same type of support system I used to find through my homemaking and pen-pal magazines. According to BSM Media, over 75 percent of moms are on Facebook and 76 percent are "fans" of at least one company. Moms rely heavily on the Internet to learn about the products they need and connect with other moms to exchange opinions about retailers and products.

And to save money, of course.

The brands that have been most successful using social media to attract consumers are those that offer coupons and discounts. One fourth of respondents to a survey conducted by Chadwick Martin Bailey said that